Media Advisory for 8:30 a.m. on Tuesday, January 14, 2025

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Santa Clara County Family and Children Service Workers Demand Agency Changes and Accountability After Baby Phoenix's Preventable Death

Press Conference Scheduled for Tuesday, January 14, 2025 at 8:30 a.m.

What: In the aftermath of Baby Phoenix's tragic death (click here for background information), frontline workers are raising urgent concerns about systemic failures and dangerous understaffing conditions in the Santa Clara County Department of Family and Children's Services (DFCS).

Social workers and support staff will hold a press conference to demand immediate action to protect the safety and well-being of vulnerable children and families.

> *"The heart-wrenching loss of Baby Phoenix highlights the devastating consequences of a broken system which desperately needs investment, attention, and urgent changes to care for children and families who are paying the price with their lives. We need immediate intervention and our local elected leaders, managers and system must be transformed. We must have these changes to ensure no family or child is left unprotected in Santa Clara County."*
> **— Pa Chang, Santa Clara County Social Work Supervisor and SEIU 521 union member with 20 years of service**

Who: Speakers will include frontline social workers, child advocates, and community leaders.

When: Tuesday, January 14, 2025, 8:30 a.m.

Where: 70 West Hedding Street, San Jose, CA 95110

Why: Chronic understaffing and lack of resources in child and family services have led to unsafe working conditions, service shortages, and preventable death or injuries that jeopardize the well-being of children and families. Social workers and support staff demand systemic changes to prioritize safety, equity, and justice for the most vulnerable members of our community.

Visuals: Children shoes to highlight the unsafe conditions

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Service Employees International Union, Local 521 represents 53,000 public- and nonprofit, private-sector workers in California's Bay Area, the Central Coast, and in the Central Valley. Under a Community First vision, we are committed to making sure the needs of our community, and the vital services we provide our community, come first. We believe our communities thrive when residents, leaders and workers recognize that we are all in this together when it comes to our safety, health, and well-being.